

"PRINTING HELPS CREATE BETTER PICTURES"

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Sanjay Patil is a travel, nature, and wildlife photographer. He delved deep into the subject after retirement from a public sector organisation. Sanjay's belief that "The process of capturing the picture is not complete unless the picture is hung on the wall" made him invest in an A2+ size Epson SureColor P807 inkjet printer in the year 2018.

The ability to obtain unbeatable details, depth, colour and contrast in a print coupled with media versatility, archival substrates and pigment inks are what made him invest in a pro-grade inkjet printer. The ability to soft proof before printing, under the same roof, is an added bonus.

This investment was driven primarily because prints from his print service provider lacked good colours and tonal range and the non-availability of archival media from them.

Felix Schoeller, Canson, Epson, Hahnemühle, and Museo fine art media are what he usually stocks. Paper selection is always based on the type of image that he decides to print. He experiments with a wide variety of media since he believes that every manufacturer's media has its own typical characteristics. Sanjay prints a wide variety of subjects that includes nature, wildlife, portraits, and travel apart from taking up print orders from fellow photographers.

In terms of challenges, the total cost of ownership compared to a dye-based printer could be a deterrent for some. Additional expenses like a colour-calibrated monitor and calibration tools could further increase the investment, is what Sanjay shared.

"My sincere advice to all professional photographers or serious amateurs is to get an entry-level inkjet printer with pigment inks, for printing images. Most of us click pictures, edit and post them on social media and perhaps we will never see the pictures again. Printing our images on a good printer helps us see every detail including rich or subtle colours that we have captured. The joy of holding the prints in our hands is totally a different experience altogether. Analysing a few printed images together rather than seeing one digital image in isolation on a monitor has helped me improve my composition, and understanding of the form, colour, texture, pattern, symmetry, and geometry of the image better. The approach of seeing the images on paper rather than looking at the images on screen helps take our photography skills to a new level altogether" is how Sanjay concludes.